The AI Questions

Two near-certain questions, your two genuine stories, and the reframe that turns your research workflow from a tool demo into something that scores.

Doc 47 · Recording 10:30 tomorrow · Asset Management, Client Solutions Group · Prepared 5 November 2026

1 Solve this first: which story goes where

Your friend's list creates a clash you need to settle before you rehearse anything, because the Pictet story answers two different questions and **you cannot use it twice.**

Question	Story	Why
Walk us through your CV	All three threads, lightly	Pictet, market openings, Goldman spring week. Touch, do not land.
AI: a time you used it	**Pictet DDQ**	**Pictet goes here.** AI is near-certain; "a challenge" is not. Spend your best story on the question you will definitely get.
AI: judgement / how you use it	**Research workflow** only if the question is clearly about daily use or learning	Claude Code into NotebookLM into verification. Section 6. **See the caveat in section 5 — Saad is right that this one is situational.**
AI: accuracy and risk	**Sales email drafting**	Your backup, and arguably the cleaner answer for an accuracy question: AI drafts, a human checks and sends. Section 5.
Teamwork	House hunt	Doc 37. Unaffected.
Conflict / above and beyond / client service	The Pools job	Age 14, actual customers. Perfect for client service and it keeps Pictet free.
Why GSAM and CSG	The funnel	Doc 42, plus one line of Pictet.

> **THE ALLOCATION WORKS**
>
> Nothing is used twice. If "tell me about a challenge" *does* come up after you have already given Pictet to the AI question, fall back to the house hunt framed as a logistics challenge, or the society event. Do not retell Pictet.

2 The one idea that scores on both AI questions

Saad's framing is right and worth sharpening into a single sentence you can hang both answers on.

AI changed **how much I could do and how fast.** It did not change **what I decided was right.**

Everything that scores well on these questions is a version of that. Everything that scores badly is a version of the opposite — treating the tool as the thinker.

The reason reviewers care is specific to this industry, and saying it shows you understand the job rather than just the technology:

WHY A FINANCIAL FIRM IS NERVOUS ABOUT THIS

In your own Pictet example, a DDQ answer is effectively **a representation the firm is making to a client**, which that client then uses to justify an allocation to their board.

So the dangerous failure is not an AI output that is obviously wrong. It is one that is **plausible and wrong** — fluent, well-formatted, and incorrect in a way nobody catches until it matters.

Plausibility without accuracy is the specific risk, and naming it is the fastest way to show you have thought about this properly rather than enthusiastically.

3 The Goldman context, and the detail worth using

Your friend is right that this is gold. Goldman rolled out its in-house **GS AI Assistant** firm-wide in June 2025 after a pilot of around 10,000 staff, with versions tailored to different functions including asset and wealth management, used for summarising long documents, drafting first versions and analysing data. It runs approved models from OpenAI, Google and Anthropic **inside Goldman's own firewalled environment.** (Your friend's information, not mine — I have not verified it, so attribute it loosely: "as I understand it".)

AND HERE IS THE CONNECTION YOU SHOULD ABSOLUTELY MAKE

Goldman's position is: **AI yes, but inside controls.** Approved models, contained environment.

Which is *exactly* what you did at Pictet. You built in a sandbox precisely so you were not asking anyone to take a risk while you tested whether the idea worked.

You arrived at the same principle independently, before you knew the firm had. That is a genuinely strong thing to be able to say, and it costs you one sentence.

4 Question A: a time you used AI

Saad's eight steps, compressed into four beats for a two-minute box. The step that scores is **number four**, and most candidates skip it entirely.

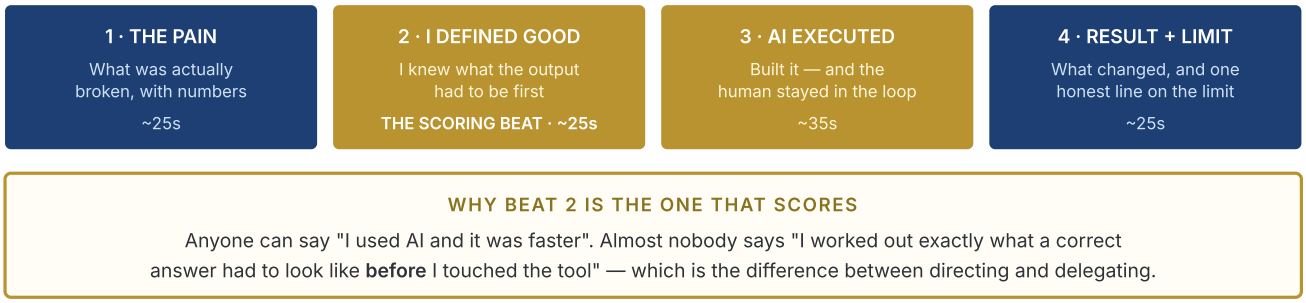


Figure 1 — Four beats, roughly 110 seconds.

BEFORE YOU WRITE A WORD OF THIS — THE HONESTY CHECK

Your friend's caution is correct and worth taking seriously. **If your manager suggested the project, do not say the idea was yours.** A Superday interviewer may well be from the team, and a mismatch with your CV or a reference is far more damaging than a less dramatic story.

The honest version is just as strong. *"The project came to me as a brief, and what I designed was…"* Ownership of the **design and the build** reads every bit as well as ownership of the idea, and it is safe. Decide tonight which is true and stick to it.

Question A, the full answer

BEAT 1 — THE PAIN, ~25 SECONDS

Thanks for watching this. So on my placement at Pictet, one of the things I worked on was rebuilding how we handled due diligence questionnaires. These are the long documents institutional clients send before they allocate — ours ran to around four hundred questions, and the answers sat with about twenty different teams. And the whole thing was being run on spreadsheets and email threads, which meant no single version of the truth and a lot of time spent chasing people for answers that already existed somewhere.

BEAT 2 — I DEFINED WHAT GOOD LOOKED LIKE, ~25 SECONDS

The thing I'd say I got right was that I worked out what the output had to be before I touched any tooling. A DDQ answer isn't really a document — it's a representation the firm is making, and the client uses it to justify an allocation to their own board. So it had to be accurate, consistent with what we'd said last time, and traceable back to an approved source. Once I'd written down what a correct answer looked like, the build was a much narrower problem.

BEAT 3 — AI EXECUTED, AND THE HUMAN STAYED IN, ~35 SECONDS

Then I used Claude Code to build it, working with one of the senior analysts. [Adjust for whose idea it was.] And we did it in a sandboxed environment deliberately, so we weren't asking anyone to take a risk on client-facing material while we tested whether the idea even worked. [If true, add: and we were only working with non-confidential material / an approved tool.]

The design point was that it never sent anything. It pulled together draft answers from material that had already been approved, and a person reviewed and signed off everything before it went near a client. Which mattered, because the dangerous failure isn't an answer that's obviously wrong — it's one that's plausible and wrong. Fluent, well-formatted, and incorrect in a way nobody catches until it matters.

BEAT 4 — RESULT AND THE LIMIT, ~25 SECONDS

[YOUR RESULT — how far it got, and one number: time per DDQ before and after, or how many it ran through.]

And the honest limit is that it made the assembly faster, it didn't make the judgement better. Somebody still had to know whether an answer was right. I think that's actually the useful lesson — it took the chasing out, which is the bit that was wasting everybody's time, and left the thinking where it was.

YOU STILL NEED ONE NUMBER — FIND IT TONIGHT

Search your emails or handover notes for: how long a DDQ took before and after, how many you ran through it, or how far it got toward adoption. **Ten minutes of searching is worth more than any rewording.** If you genuinely cannot find one, say the shape honestly — "it took roughly a day rather than most of a week" — and flag it as approximate.

5 Question B: the judgement question

Three likely wordings. The good news is that **one answer covers all three**, with a different opening sentence.

If they ask	Use
"How do you use AI day to day?" or "how do you learn?"	**The research workflow.** Straight in. Section 6.
"How do you make sure AI output is accurate?"	**The sales email story is cleaner here** — it is a work example with a client-facing consequence. Then the verification rule from the workflow as a second layer.
"How will AI change asset management or a client-facing role?"	The view first (section 7). Then *one line* of evidence, not the whole workflow.

SAAD IS RIGHT THAT THE RESEARCH WORKFLOW IS SITUATIONAL — READ THIS BEFORE YOU USE IT

He called it "a bit rogue", and the reason is fair: **describing how you used AI to prepare for the interview you are currently sitting is a slightly odd frame**, and it can read as being about the interview rather than about you.

Use it only when the question is clearly about daily use or how you learn. Then it is exactly right, because it *is* how you learn, and it has been for weeks rather than for one night.

If the question is about accuracy or risk, lead with the **sales email** story instead — it is a work example, it has a real client-facing consequence, and the human-in-the-loop point is built into it rather than bolted on.

Your backup: the sales email story

Short, clean, and the structure makes the point for you: **Claude drafts, a human checks, a human sends.**

ROUGHLY 45 SECONDS, IF YOU NEED IT

"A simpler example is drafting client emails. I'd use Claude to get a first version down, which takes the blank-page problem away — but nothing went out without a person reading it properly and deciding whether it was right. And that's not a formality. The failure you're worried about isn't a draft that's obviously wrong, it's one that reads perfectly well and says something slightly off — and the only thing that catches that is somebody who knows the client and knows what we'd actually said before. So the drafting got quicker and the deciding stayed exactly where it was."

6 Your workflow, reframed

You called it "a filtering process". That undersells it, and I think you have not seen what you are actually doing.

HOW YOU DESCRIBED IT	WHAT YOU ARE ACTUALLY DOING
"I use AI as a filtering process. I start with a lot of information, listen and read through it, and select the ones I like." **Problem:** "filtering" and "the ones I like" sound passive and subjective. It makes you the consumer of the output rather than the designer of the process.	Four distinct things, and only one of them is filtering: **Expand** — gather far more than you could read. **Convert** — text into audio, which changes *when* you can consume it. **Triage** — flag what is worth depth. **Verify** — go back to the original source for anything you will actually use.

The sentence to use: **"It changed how much I could cover and where I could cover it. It didn't change what I decided was true."**

Two things in your workflow you have not noticed

1. YOU CONVERTED DEAD TIME INTO READING TIME

The podcast step is not about the format being fun. **It means the learning happens in time that was not previously available** — walking, travelling, whatever. You did not read faster. You found hours that did not exist before.

That is a genuine efficiency insight and it is much more interesting than "I use a tool that makes podcasts."

2. GOING BACK TO THE SOURCE IS THE WHOLE ANSWER TO "HOW DO YOU CHECK ACCURACY"

You said it almost in passing: anything you found particularly interesting, you go back and reread the original articles before you use it.

That is the human-in-the-loop step, and it is the single highest-scoring thing in this answer. Say it clearly and say it as a rule: *"I don't quote anything I haven't read in the original."*

It is also true, which is why it will sound true.

Question B, the full answer

OPEN, ~15 SECONDS

Thanks for watching. The way I'd put it is that AI changed how much I could cover and where I could cover it — it didn't change what I decided was true. And the clearest example is how I've been building up commercial awareness for this.

THE WORKFLOW, ~40 SECONDS

So I'll use Claude Code to pull together a lot of material on something — say UK pensions policy, which is what I've been reading about recently. Far more than I'd realistically sit and read. Then I put it into NotebookLM, which turns it into an audio summary I can listen to.

And that bit matters more than it sounds, because it means the reading happens in time I didn't previously have — walking, travelling, that sort of thing. I'm not reading faster, I've just found hours that weren't there.

Then anything that actually interests me, I go back to the original article and read it properly.

THE RULE, ~25 SECONDS

And I'd say that last step is the important one. I've got a rule that I don't quote anything I haven't read in the original. Partly because summaries drop the caveats, and the caveats are usually where the interesting bit is. But mostly because the risk with this stuff isn't an output that's obviously wrong — it's one that's plausible and wrong. Fluent, confident, and not quite right.

So I use it to widen what I look at, and I keep the deciding bit myself.

CLOSE, ~20 SECONDS

And I suppose what I took from doing it at Pictet as well is the same principle. We built that in a sandbox deliberately, and kept a person signing off anything client-facing — which, as I understand it, is roughly how Goldman has approached it too, running approved models inside its own environment. Which seems right to me: the useful question isn't whether to use it, it's what it's allowed to touch.

7 If they ask the forward-looking version

"How will AI change asset management, or a client-facing role like CSG?" This needs a view, and the lazy one is everywhere.

WHAT EVERYONE SAYS

"It will automate routine tasks and free people up to focus on higher-value work and building relationships."

True, generic, and worth nothing. It could be said about any industry by anyone who has read one article.

A VIEW WITH SOMETHING IN IT

"It makes *producing* things cheap, which means the bottleneck moves to *checking* them. In a job where the document is a representation the firm is making, verification becomes the scarce thing, not drafting."

Specific, non-obvious, and drawn from your own experience.

Two more lines you can use, either of which lands:

- **"What's being sold is accountability, and that can't be automated."** A client is not paying for the document. They are paying for a named institution to stand behind it. AI can draft the answer; it cannot be accountable for it.
- **"The scarce skill stops being capacity and becomes knowing what right looks like."** If anyone can produce a plausible answer in seconds, the person who can tell a correct one from a plausible one becomes more valuable, not less.

8 What never to say about AI

The one that could actually sink you: never mention using any tool in connection with an online assessment. Saad is emphatic and he is right — **it reads as cheating**, and no amount of context recovers it on a recording. The wider rule: **never describe an AI use that could be read as circumventing a process you were meant to complete yourself.** If in doubt, leave it out.

Never	Because
Anything involving an assessment tool	**See above.** This is the single most damaging thing available to you.
Pictet client names, or anything confidential	You are describing a former employer's work to a competitor. Describe the *shape* — "institutional clients", "a large pension scheme" — never the name. Being visibly careful is itself a mark in your favour.
A project that was not yours	The private markets fundraising research was Kieran's. **Do not use it.** A Superday interviewer from that team will know, and one invented story contaminates every true one.
"I asked Claude to fix it" / "I got AI to do it"	Describes delegation, not direction. Say what you designed and what you checked.
"AI is going to transform the industry"	Says nothing. Everyone says it. Give a mechanism instead.
"It saves me loads of time"	Vague. Say what time, doing what, and what you did with it.
"I use it for everything"	Reads as over-reliance, which is the specific worry.
Anything implying you skipped the checking	Fatal in a regulated firm.
Naming a tool as though the tool is the point	Name tools for specificity, not to impress. The process is the answer, not the product.
Over-claiming your Pictet role	See the warning in section 4. A Superday interviewer may be from that team.

> **One disclosure, since you are naming tools.** I am Claude, made by Anthropic, so take my view on naming it with that in mind. My honest advice: **name the tools because specificity is credible, not because any tool is impressive.** "I used Claude Code to build it" is better than "I used AI" for the same reason "eight billion into property" beats "most of it". The reviewer is assessing your process, not your software.

9 Tonight, in order

1. **Decide whose idea the Pictet project was,** and write the one sentence accordingly. Ten minutes, and it de-risks a Superday.
2. **Confirm what you can honestly say about the data and the tool** — firm-approved, non-confidential material, or neither. If either is true it is worth one clause; if neither is, say nothing rather than implying it.
3. **Find your number.** Search emails for the DDQ before-and-after. Ten minutes.
4. **Learn four beats and three facts for Question A** — 400 questions, 20 teams, your result number. Nothing else.
5. **Learn the single sentence for Question B** — *changed how much I could cover, not what I decided was true* — plus the rule about originals.

6. **Film each one eight to ten times**, changing the words, keeping the beats fixed. This matters more than any further reading.
7. **Check the allocation table in section 1** so you do not spend Pictet on the wrong question.

> **IF YOU REMEMBER ONE THING AT 10:30 TOMORROW**
>
> **You are the one who decided what good looked like. The tool is how it got built.** Every sentence in both answers should be consistent with that, and the reviewer's only real question is whether you would be the sort of person who checks.

Sourcing. The question predictions, the GS AI Assistant details and the two cautions all come from your friends Saad and Angeline — **I have not verified any of it**, so attribute the Goldman AI details loosely ("as I understand it") rather than stating them as fact. The DDQ figures of roughly 400 questions across 20 teams come from your own earlier account and should be checked. Everything bracketed is yours to supply. The framing of plausibility-without-accuracy as the specific risk, the four-stage reading of your workflow, the dead-time observation and the verification-becomes-the-bottleneck view are my additions. One disclosure repeated from section 8: I am Claude, made by Anthropic, and you should weigh my advice about naming AI tools accordingly.